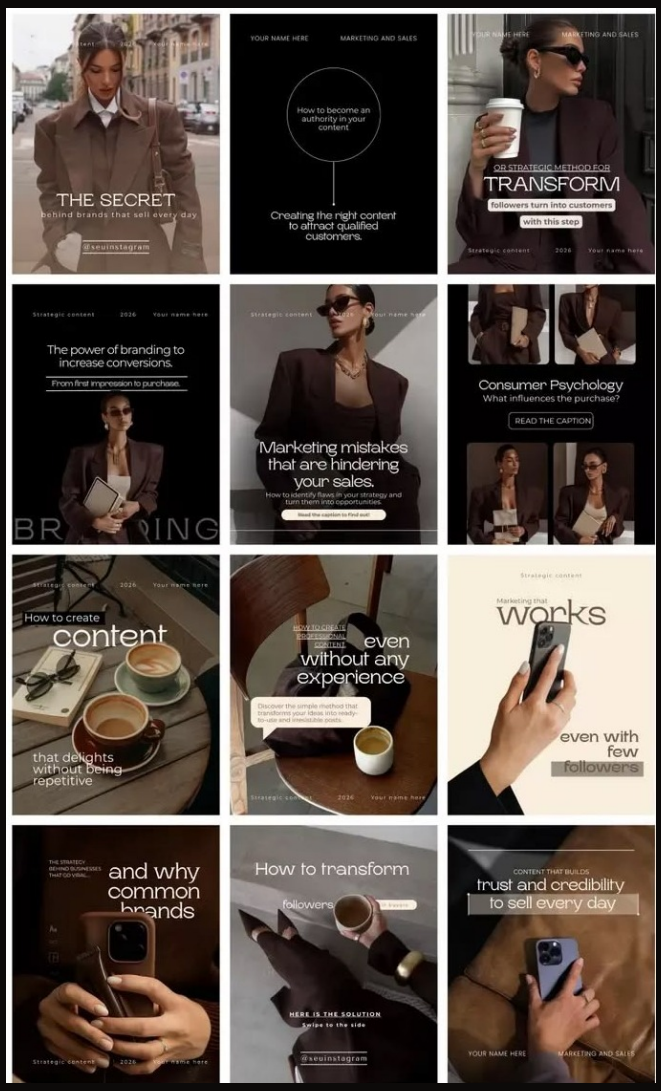
CASE STUDY | PERSONAL BRAND SOCIAL DESIGN

Strategic Content

Instagram Carousel Series

A dark, editorial feed that turns marketing advice into authority, trust and sales.



ROLE
Social Media Designer

DELIVERABLE
12 slide feed system

PLATFORM
Instagram feed

01 PROJECT OVERVIEW

A feed that sells authority before it sells anything else

This project is a 12 slide Instagram carousel system for a marketing and sales expert. The topics are practical: content strategy, branding, consumer psychology and turning followers into customers. The design treats the expert like a premium fashion brand, using polished lifestyle photography, a dark palette and clean modern type, so the advice feels as credible as the person giving it. Header fields such as YOUR NAME HERE, MARKETING AND SALES, Strategic content and 2026 make the set a customisable template.

Project	Instagram carousel and grid system, 12 slides
Language	English
Theme	Marketing, branding, content strategy and sales psychology
Format	Portrait feed posts with a repeatable header and footer frame
Role	Art direction, photo selection, typography, layout and final design

Skills used

Art direction	Building a luxury, quiet look from dark browns, black and warm cream.
Editorial typography	A wide modern sans with small caps labels, underlines and pill highlights.
Layout design	Mixing photo led, text led and split layouts to keep a long set lively.
Content hierarchy	Hook, supporting line and call to action arranged for fast scanning.
Conversion thinking	Using Read the caption, Swipe to the side and Here is the solution prompts.

Deliverables

- 12 finished carousel slides with hooks, descriptions and calls to action.
- A header and footer frame with name, niche, year and handle placeholders.
- A defined palette, type system and photography direction.
- A planned 3 by 4 profile grid mixing dark, mid tone and light tiles.

02 THE CHALLENGE

Make marketing advice look like a luxury brand

Marketing and sales content is usually bright, busy and full of arrows, emojis and bold promises. That style competes on noise. The aim here was to compete on taste: help a strategist look senior, trustworthy and premium, while still giving practical, scannable lessons.

Key problems

- **Credibility.** Many experts in the niche look alike, so visual trust had to set this one apart.
- **Dense topics.** Psychology, branding and conversion ideas needed to become short hooks.
- **Consistency.** Studio style portraits, coffee tables and phone shots had to feel like one brand.
- **Clear action.** Every post still needed a prompt: read the caption, swipe or follow.

Goals

Authority	Present the expert with the polish of a fashion or lifestyle label.
Education	Deliver clear lessons on branding, content and buyer behaviour.
Conversion	Guide followers from interest to caption, to profile, to purchase.
Scalability	Create a flexible system that can be reused for any expert niche.

Audience

- Small business owners and freelancers who want to sell more through Instagram.
- Aspiring content creators who feel their posts lack direction.
- Followers who respond to taste, calm confidence and clear explanations.

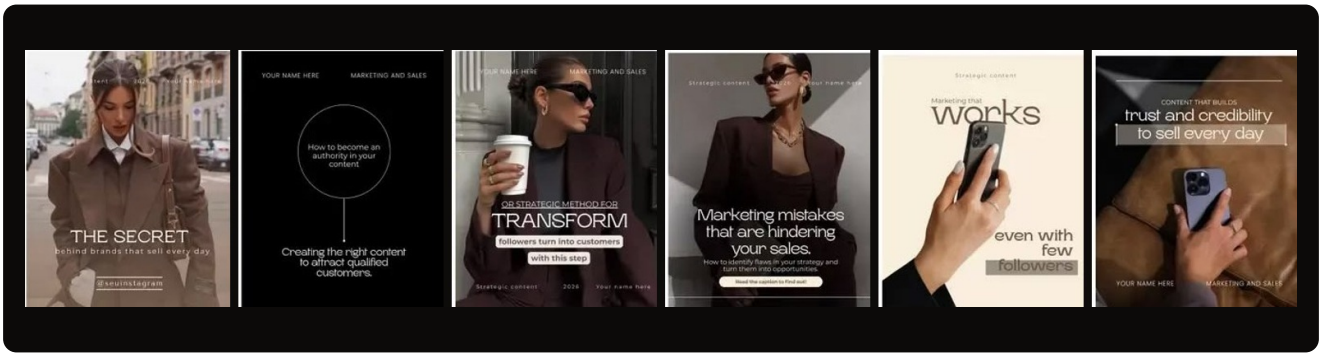
Four content pillars across the grid

Each slide belongs to a pillar, so the profile teaches a full story and not just isolated tips.

Pillar	Slides	Purpose
Authority	"The secret behind brands that sell every day" and "How to become an authority in your content".	Set expertise and promise
Branding	"The power of branding to increase conversions" and "Content that builds trust and credibility".	Show why look and message matter
Strategy	"Marketing mistakes that are hindering your sales" and "Consumer Psychology".	Teach, diagnose and explain
Growth	"How to create content that delights", "Marketing that works even with few followers" and "How to transform followers into buyers".	Offer a path to results

Why this works

- Headlines open a curiosity gap (the secret, the mistakes, the solution) that invites a swipe or a read.
- Prompts such as Read the caption and Swipe to the side move the viewer to the next action.
- Mixing teaching, diagnosis and solution slides makes the feed feel complete and not repetitive.



Dark neutrals, warm leather and one soft light slide

Studio Black
#0C0A09

Statement slides, contrast

Chocolate
#3A231B

Blazers, leather, depth

Caramel
#A27553

Accents, rules, highlights

Taupe
#A89A8C

Secondary text, soft neutrals

Cream
#F2E8D8

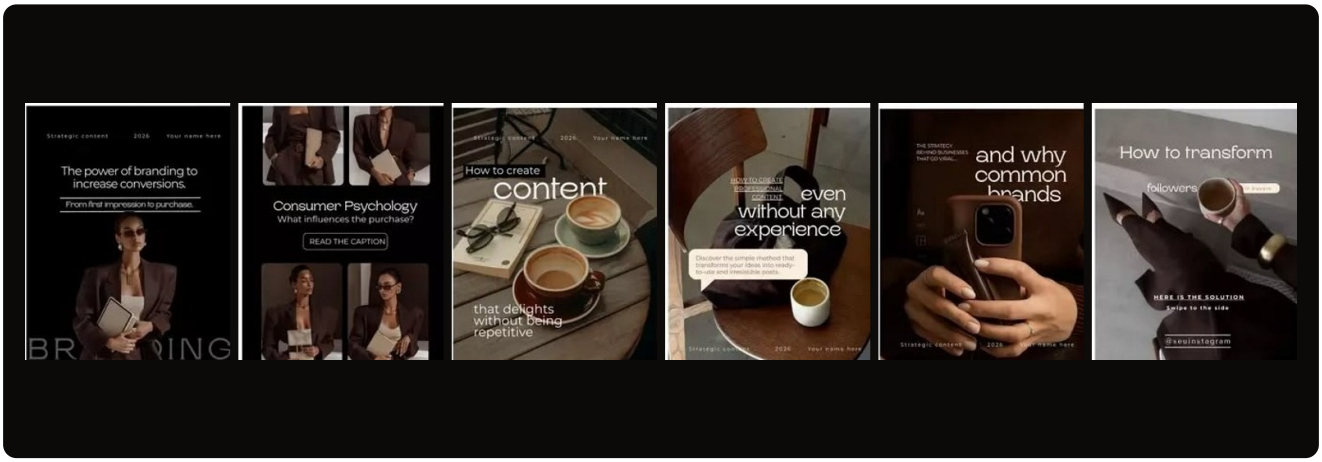
Light slides and pill tags

Typography

Headline sans	A wide, modern geometric sans in lower case and sentence case. Headlines are large, with space around them.
Small caps labels	Tiny, spaced capitals for lead ins and prompts, such as THE STRATEGY BEHIND BUSINESSES and HERE IS THE SOLUTION.
Pill highlight	A soft rounded tag behind key phrases (followers turn into customers, read the caption) to mark action and emphasis.
Rules and lines	Thin underlines and vertical lines guide the eye and add a refined, architectural feel.
Header and footer	A discreet frame: name, niche, strategic content and year, the same on every tile.

Design principles

- Keep headlines short and set in clear space beside or below the subject.
- Use colour from the photo itself (chocolate coats, leather, wood) so type feels part of the scene.
- Reserve the cream slide for a moment of lightness in the middle of the grid.
- Avoid stickers, arrows and loud colour so the brand stays calm and credible.



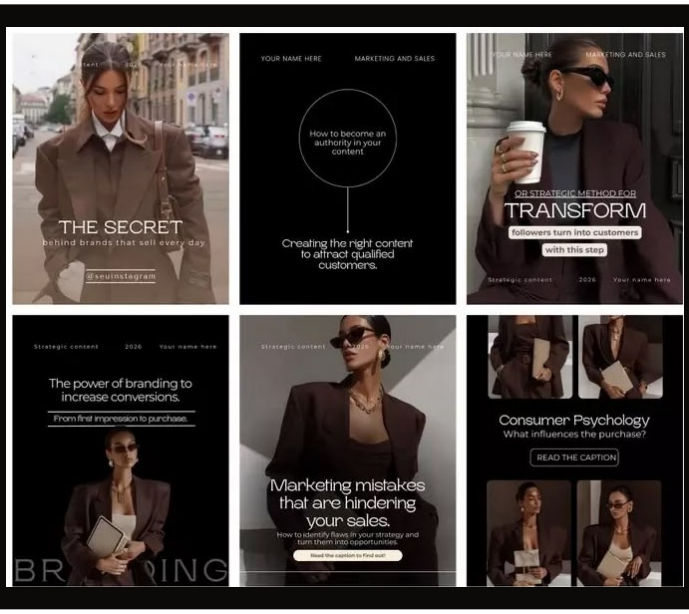
Seven layouts keep a long set dynamic

Layout	Structure	Used on
A. Full photo statement	A portrait fills the frame with a centred headline and a small underlined handle.	Slides 01, 03, 05
B. Black minimal	Pure black with a thin circle and a vertical line leading to a closing line of text.	Slide 02
C. Subject with ghost word	Model below a headline, with an oversized faded word cropped at the base.	Slide 04
D. Two up photo split	Two framed photos with a headline and a button style prompt between them.	Slide 06
E. Lifestyle object	A coffee table or hand with phone, with text placed in the open area.	Slides 07, 08, 10, 11
F. Light cream slide	A soft cream background with large dark type and a highlighted word.	Slide 09
G. Credibility close	A hand holding a phone, with a highlighted statement across the top.	Slide 12

Grid rhythm

Dark, mid tone and light tiles alternate across each row so the profile never feels heavy. Close up lifestyle shots sit between portrait slides, and the single cream tile acts as a visual rest point.

- Every row includes at least one portrait and one object or lifestyle tile.
- Text sits left, centre and right in turn, so the eye moves across the grid.
- A consistent header and footer frame ties very different photos together.



06 SLIDE BREAKDOWN

What each slide does

Slide	Role in the story
01 The secret behind brands that sell every day	Street style portrait with a curiosity hook and the handle underneath. A cover that sets a luxury tone.
02 How to become an authority in your content	Black slide with a circle and line. Minimal and bold, it frames the main promise.
03 Strategic method to transform followers into customers	Portrait with coffee and highlighted pill text that shows the transformation.
04 The power of branding to increase conversions	Model with a notebook and a giant ghost word, BRANDING, to anchor the topic.
05 Marketing mistakes that are hindering your sales	Portrait with sunglasses, a bold headline and a Read the caption button.
06 Consumer Psychology: what influences the purchase?	Two photo frames around a headline and a button, which gives a structured, educational feel.
07 How to create content that delights without being repetitive	Cafe table with coffee and a book. Warm and relatable.
08 How to create professional content even without any experience	Cafe scene with a speech bubble that explains the simple method.
09 Marketing that works even with few followers	Light cream slide with a hand and phone, giving the grid a breath of space.
10 The strategy behind businesses that go viral	Close up of hands with a leather phone case, hinting at behind the scenes insight.
11 How to transform followers into buyers	Hand with coffee and a prompt, Here is the solution, then Swipe to the side.
12 Content that builds trust and credibility to sell every day	Closing statement over leather and a phone, repeating the core promise.

Headlines that continue from one slide to the next

Several headlines appear to run on from one tile to its neighbour, for example "How to create content" continuing into "even without any experience", and "How to transform" into "followers". This turns a swipe into a reading rhythm and makes the profile grid feel like one long sentence.

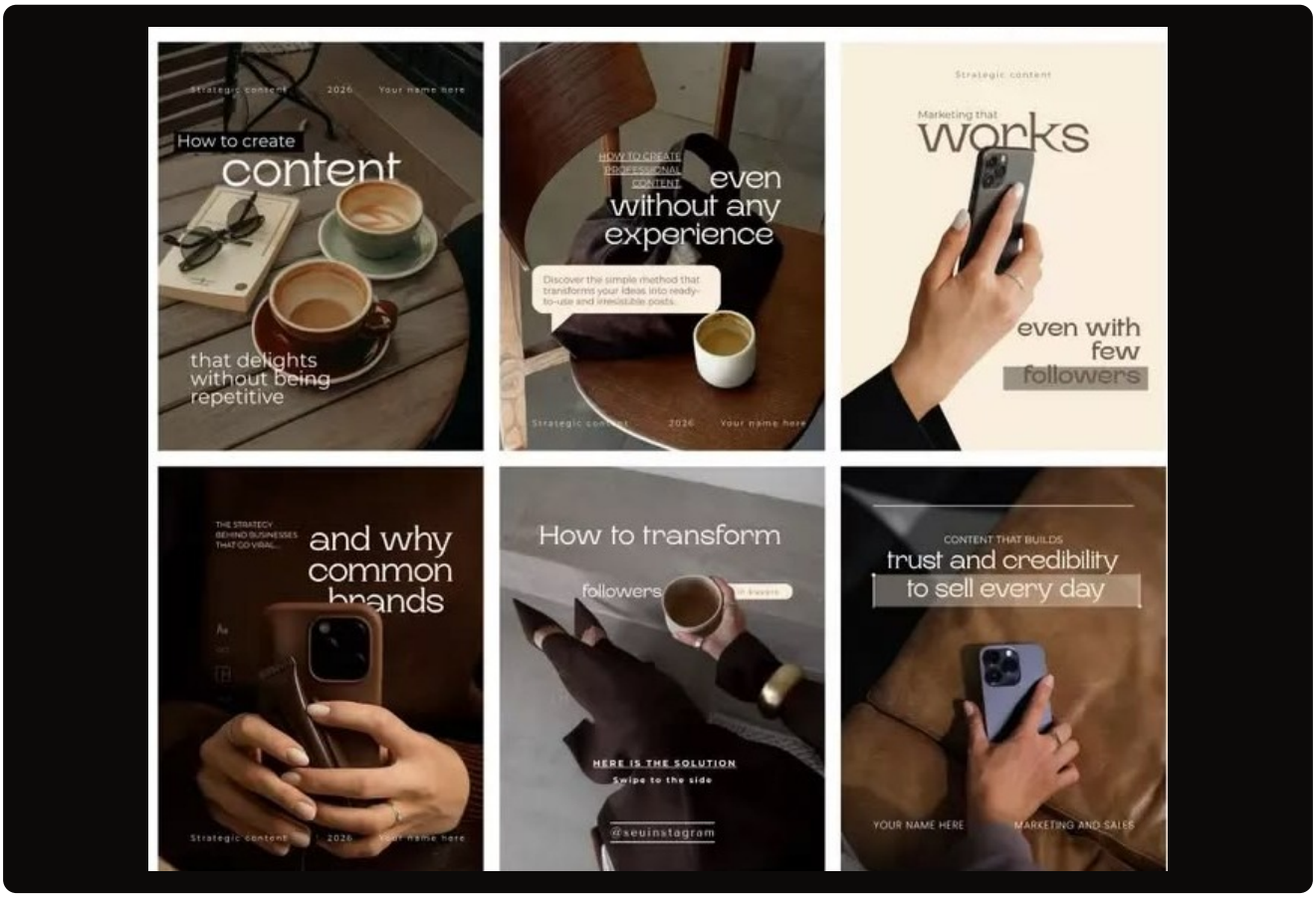


Why it helps

- It rewards the swipe, because the sentence is finished on the next slide.
- It gives the profile grid a designed, deliberate look.
- It lets long messages fit in short, large type without crowding a single slide.

Quiet, tailored and slightly cinematic

Subjects	A woman in tailored chocolate blazers, sunglasses and gold jewellery, plus coffee, a notebook, a bag and a phone.
Settings	European street, wooden cafe table, leather sofa and a dark studio.
Light	Soft natural light with deep shadows for a moody, premium feel.
Crops	Mix of full portrait, torso and hands, so the set has rhythm without losing consistency.
Grade	Warm and slightly desaturated, with rich dark browns and gentle highlights.
Negative space	Each frame keeps an open area, such as wall, table or sky, so type has room.



What the project shows

- **Taste builds trust.** A fashion level look made marketing advice feel more credible.
- **Rhythm beats repetition.** Seven layouts and a single light slide keep a twelve slide set fresh.
- **Prompts convert.** Small calls to action turn passive viewers into readers and followers.
- **A template mindset.** Placeholder fields make the system reusable for any expert or niche.

Project snapshot

Format	Instagram carousel of 12 slides
System	Seven layouts with one light slide for rhythm
Profile grid	Planned 3 by 4 mix of dark, mid tone and light tiles
Designer's note	"Good design earns trust before the advice is even read."

Design note by Tomisin, the designer of this project.

Tools

Design: Canva, Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Illustrator, Figma and Adobe Express.
Content: CapCut, Meta Business Suite, Pinterest, plus Freepik or Envato for stock assets.

Let's make your expertise look as good as it is.
Social media design, carousels and brand led content.